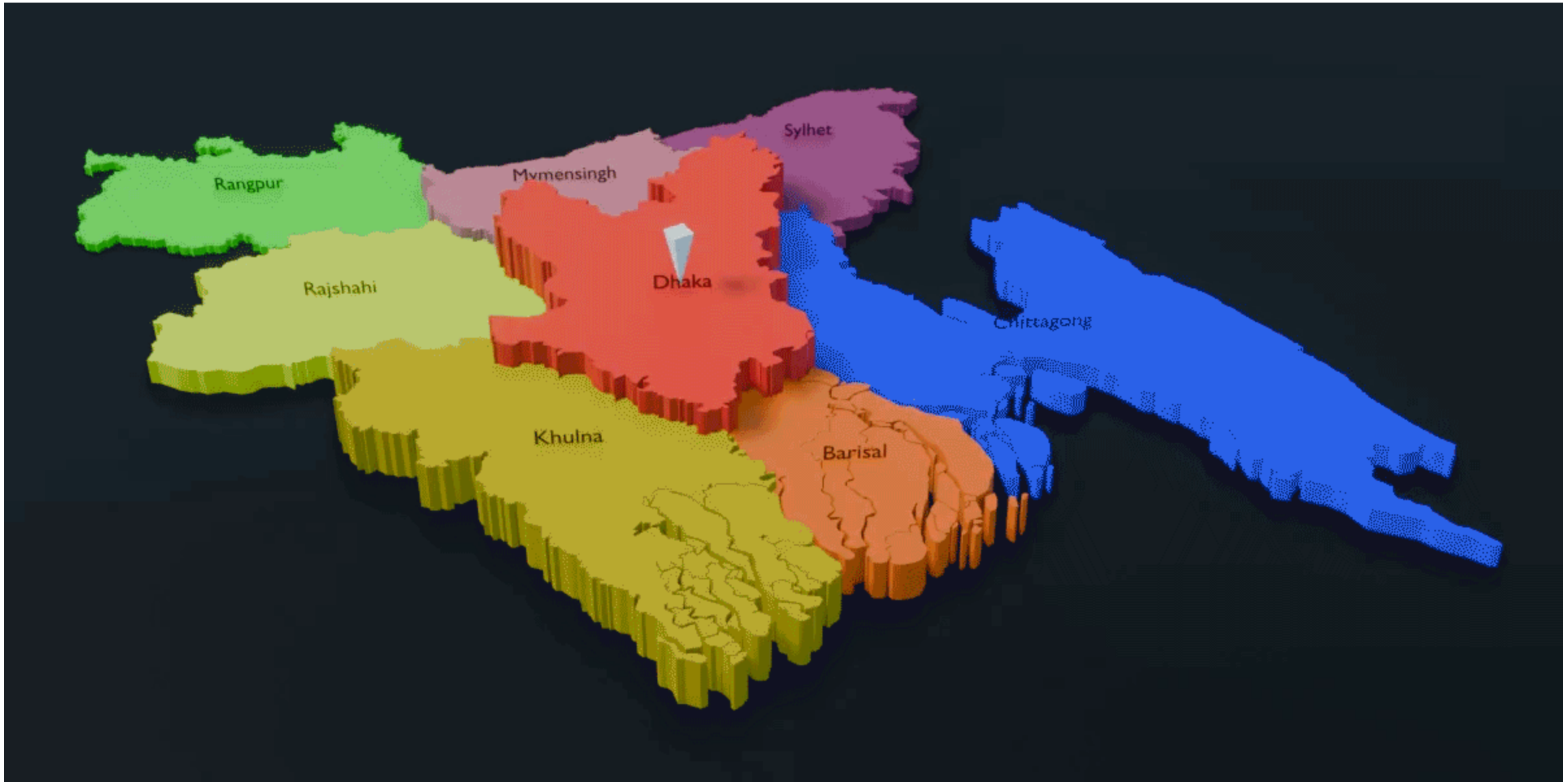
Exploring the Administrative Divisions of Bangladesh


Rangpur
Mymensingh
Sylhet
Rajshahi
Dhaka
Chittagong
Khulna
Barisal

- The administrative structure of Bangladesh currently comprises Eight divisions (Bengali: bibhag) : Barishal, Chattogram, Dhaka, Khulna, Rajshahi, Rangpur, Mymensingh and Sylhet at the first-order administrative level.

- Each division is named after the major city within its jurisdiction that serves as the administrative capital of that division.

- The divisions are subdivided into 64 districts (Bengali: zila) at the second-order administrative level, then into approximately 495 sub-districts (Bengali: thana or upazila), and Finally, into 652 thana (2022), union 4,578 (2022), mouza 59,990, village 87,362; city corporation 12 (Dhaka North City Corporation, Dhaka South City Corporation, Chittagong city corporation, Khulna city corporation, Rajshahi city corporation, Sylhet city corporation, Barisal city corporation, Rangpur City Corporation, Mymensingh City Corporation, Narayanganj city corporation, Comilla city corporation, Gazipur City Corporation); municipality 331 (2022).

Source: *Banglapedia*



Division	Districts	Name of the districts
Barishal	6	Barguna, Barishal, Bhola, Jhalokati, Patuakhali, Pirojpur
Chattogram	11	Bandarban, Brahmanbaria, Chandpur, Chattogram, Cumilla, Cox's Bazar, Feni, Khagrachari, Lakshmipur, Noakhali, Rangamati
Dhaka	13	Dhaka, Faridpur, Gazipur, Gopalganj, Kishoreganj, Madaripur, Manikganj, Munshiganj, Narayanganj
Khulna	10	Bagerhat, Chuadanga, Jashore, Jhenaidah, Khulna, Kushtia, Magura, Meherpur, Narail, Satkhira
Mymensingh	4	Jamalpur, Mymensingh, Netrokona, Sherpur
Rajshahi	8	Bogura, Jaipurhat, Naogaon, Natore, Nawabganj, Pabna, Rajshahi, Sirajganj
Rangpur	8	Dinajpur, Gaibandha, Kurigram, Lalmonirhat, Nilphamari, Panchagarh, Rangpur, Thakurgaon
Sylhet	4	Habiganj, Moulvibazar, Sunamganj, Sylhet

Division-wise Population Distribution in Bangladesh in 2022

Division	Population Number (million)	% of Population	Dependency Ratio	Literacy Rate %
Bangladesh	169.83	100	52.64	74.66
Barishal	9.33	5.49	57.72	77.57
Chattogram	34.18	20.13	59.97	76.53
Dhaka	45.64	26.88	46.32	78.09
Khulna	17.81	10.49	48.00	75.02
Mymensingh	12.64	7.44	60.33	67.09
Rajshahi	20.79	12.24	48.89	71.91
Rangpur	18.02	10.61	53.09	70.75
Sylhet	11.42	6.72	60.10	71.92

Source: *https://www.researchgate.net/publication/378057385*

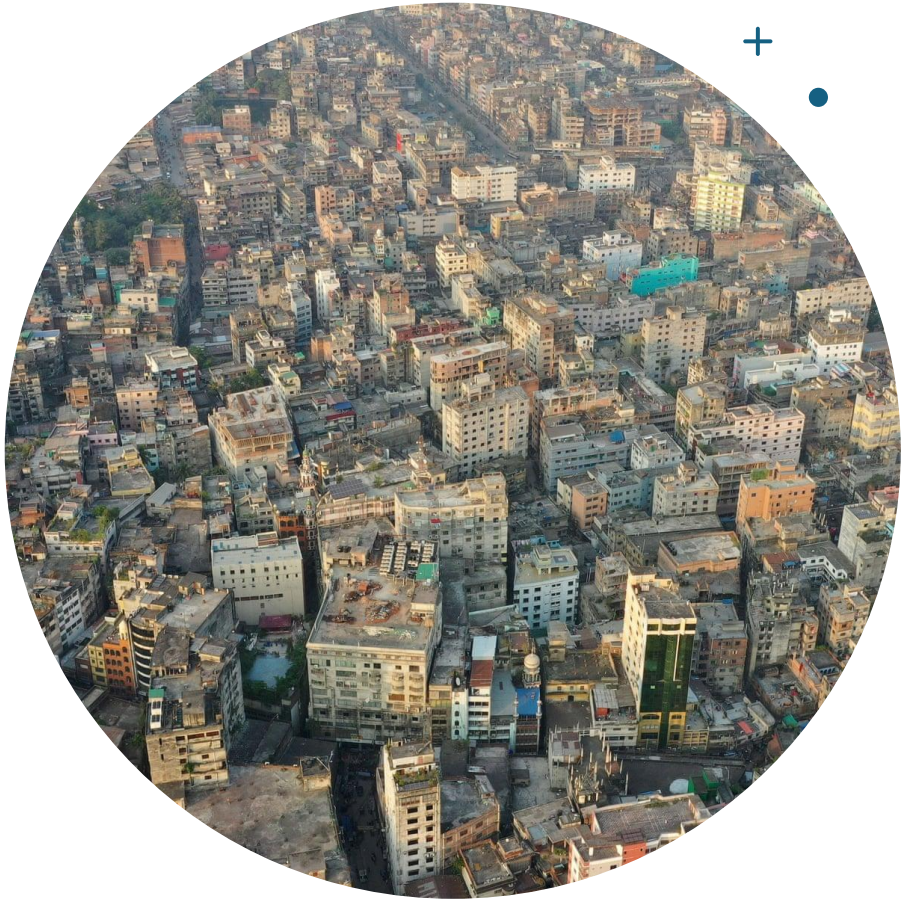


DHAKA



Dhaka Division

- Dhaka division was formed in 1829.
- Dhaka serves as the capital city of the Dhaka Division, the Dhaka District, and Bangladesh.
- Dhaka is the largest city in the country. It comes among the 10 most populated cities in the world.
- The division remains a population magnet, covering an area of 20,508.8 km2 with a population of over 44 million, it is one of the fastest-growing populous administrative divisions of the world, growing at a 1.94% rate since the prior count, compared with a national average of 1.22%.



Location

- The division is bordered by Mymensingh Division to the north, Barisal Division to the south, Chittagong Division to the east and southeast, Sylhet Division to the northeast, Rajshahi Division to the west, and Khulna Division to the southwest.

- The Buriganga (Budiganga) and her mother river Dhaleswari (Dhaleshvari) connect Dhaka to the great rivers and through them with almost all districts of Bengal.



Administrative Structure

The total 13 districts of Dhaka Division are:

1. Narsingdi District
2. Gazipur District
3. Shariatpur District
4. Narayanganj District
5. Tangail District
6. Kishoreganj District
7. Manikganj District
8. Dhaka District
9. Munshiganj District
10. Rajbari District
11. Madaripur District
12. Gopalganj District
13. Faridpur district



CITY CORPORATIONS

- Dhaka municipality was established in 1864, and it was turned into a Town Committee in 1960.
- The Town Committee was abolished in 1972, and it was upgraded into a Municipal Corporation in 1983, and it was turned into a City Corporation in 1990.
- In 2011, Dhaka City Corporation was split into two separate corporations – Dhaka North City Corporation and Dhaka South City
- Corporation which is headed by two mayors, elected for 5 years. The area within the city
- Corporations were divided into 130 wards and 841 Mouzas and Mohallas.
- Gazipur City Corporation and Narayangonj City Corporations are also included in the Dhaka Division.



Dhaka North City Corporation



Dhaka South City Corporation

City Corporation (Census 2001)

City Corporation	Metropolitan Thana	Ward and Union	Mahalla and Mouza
2	41	81+ 59 (Part)	841

Source: *https://en.banglapedia.org/index.php/Dhaka_District*

DEMOGRAPHY

Muslims are the predominant religion with 93.40%, while Hindus are 6.26% population. Christians and others are 0.28% and 0.06% respectively.

Out of 44,213,278 population, 41,295,740 are Muslims, 2,766,723 are Hindus, 124,349 are Christians, 20,341 are Buddhist, with some other faiths small population.

ETYMOLOGY

- The origins of the name Dhaka are uncertain. It may derive from the dhak tree, which was once common in the area, or from Dhakeshwari, the 'patron goddess' of the region.

- Another popular theory states that Dhaka refers to a membranophone instrument, dhak which was played by order of Subahdar Islam Khan during the inauguration of the Bengal capital in 1610.

- According to Rajatarangini written by a Kashmiri Brahman, Kalhana, the region was originally known as Dhakka. The word Dhakka means watchtower. Bikrampur and Sonargaon—the earlier strongholds of Bengal rulers were situated nearby. So, Dhaka was most likely used as the watchtower for the fortification purpose.

Dhaka City: The Capital of Bangladesh



- Dhaka is the capital of Bangladesh.
- Located on the Buriganga River in the heart of the Bengal delta
- Dhaka city, one of the most densely populated cities in the world.
- Dhaka's(Greater Dhaka) 2024 population is now estimated at 23,935,700.21 million people.(World Population Review)
- In 2022, approximately 10.28 million people lived in Dhaka city, making it the biggest city in Bangladesh. (Aaron O'Neill Sep 11, 2024)
- The city is described as the *Rickshaw Capital of the World*.

Source:
https://www.statista.com/statistics/438201/largest-cities-in-bangladesh/

- The main commercial areas of the city include Motijheel, Dilkusha, Paltan, New Market, Shahbag, Gulshan, Mohakhali, Karwan Bazar and Farmgate.

- Tejgaon and Hazaribagh are the major industrial areas.











History of Dhaka

Dhaka's existence was from the pre-Muslim period, But it grew as an urban center in the Sultanate period.

In the Mughal period when it enjoyed the position of a provincial capital at that time known as **Jahangirnagar.**

Pre-Mughal Rule

- *Dhaka was part of the ancient district of Bikrampur, which was ruled by the Sena dynasty.*
- *Under Islamic rule, it became part of Sonargaon, the regional administrative hub of the Delhi and Bengal Sultanates.*

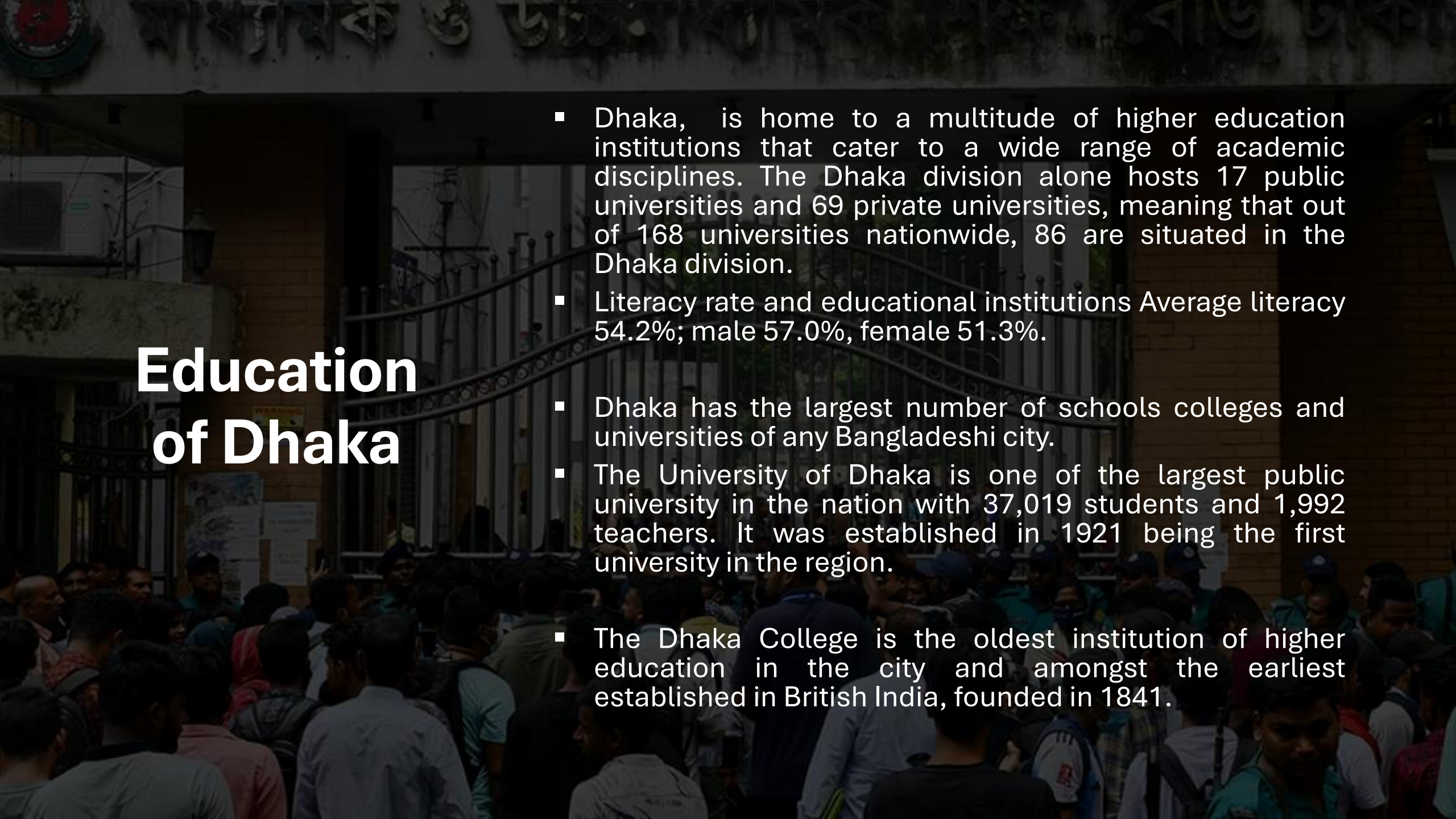


HISTORY



Under Mughal rule, the Old **City** of **Dhaka** grew on the banks of the Buriganga River. **Dhaka** was proclaimed the capital of Mughal Bengal in 1608.

Islam Khan Chishti was the first administrator of the **city**. Khan named it "Jahangirabad" (**City** of Jahangir) in honor of the Emperor Jahangir.



Education of Dhaka

- Dhaka, is home to a multitude of higher education institutions that cater to a wide range of academic disciplines. The Dhaka division alone hosts 17 public universities and 69 private universities, meaning that out of 168 universities nationwide, 86 are situated in the Dhaka division.
- Literacy rate and educational institutions Average literacy 54.2%; male 57.0%, female 51.3%.
- Dhaka has the largest number of schools colleges and universities of any Bangladeshi city.
- The University of Dhaka is one of the largest public university in the nation with 37,019 students and 1,992 teachers. It was established in 1921 being the first university in the region.
- The Dhaka College is the oldest institution of higher education in the city and amongst the earliest established in British India, founded in 1841.

Educational Institutions of **DHAKA**



- Dhaka has the largest number of schools ,colleges and universities among any Bangladeshi cities.

- Dhaka Division is home to 17 public universities, among which 9 are in Dhaka City.
- Number of Public Universities 17
- Number of Private Universities 67

Education (Universities and Colleges)



BUET



Dhaka Medical College



University of Dhaka



Jahangirnagar University



Dhaka College



Jagannath University

Public and Private Universities in Dhaka

- University of Dhaka
- Dhaka Medical College
- Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology
- Jahangirnagar University
- Ahsanullah University of Science and Technology
- Bangladesh University of Textiles
- Bangladesh University of Professionals
- Military Institute of Science and Technology
- BRAC University
- North South University
- American International University-Bangladesh
- Independent University, Bangladesh
- Daffodil International University
- Islamic University of Technology
- Jagannath University
- Sher-e-Bangla Agricultural University

Top Schools and Colleges in Dhaka

1. Viqarunnisa Noon School and College
2. Government Laboratory High School
3. Ideal School and College
4. Rajuk Uttara Model School & College
5. Bir Shreshtha Noor Mohammad Public College
6. Dhaka Residential Model College
7. Holy Cross Girls' High School and College
8. St Joseph Higher Secondary School
9. Monipur High School and College
10. Notre Dame College
11. Adamjee Cantonment College
12. Dhaka City College
13. Dhaka College
14. BAF Shaheen College Dhaka
15. Dhaka Commerce College

Important places in Dhaka



Martyred Intellectuals Memorial

[Built- 1996-1999]



National Marty's Monument

[Built- 1978-1982]



Shaheed Minar

[Built-1952]



National Parliament House

[Built- 1961-1982]

Historical Places

- Lalbagh Fort
- Ahsan Manzil Museum
- Panam Nagar





Historical and Tourist Spots in Dhaka



National Parliament House

Jatiya Sangsad Bhaban or National Parliament House, is the house of the Parliament of Bangladesh, located at Sher-e-Bangla Nagar Dhaka



Khan Mohammad Mirza Mosque

The Khan Mohammad Mirza Mosque is a historical mosque in Dhaka, Bangladesh.



Ahsan Manjil

It is a pink palace located on the banks of the Buriganga River in Old Dhaka, Bangladesh that was once the residence of the Nawab of Dhaka. It is now a museum that showcases the lifestyle of the Nawabs.

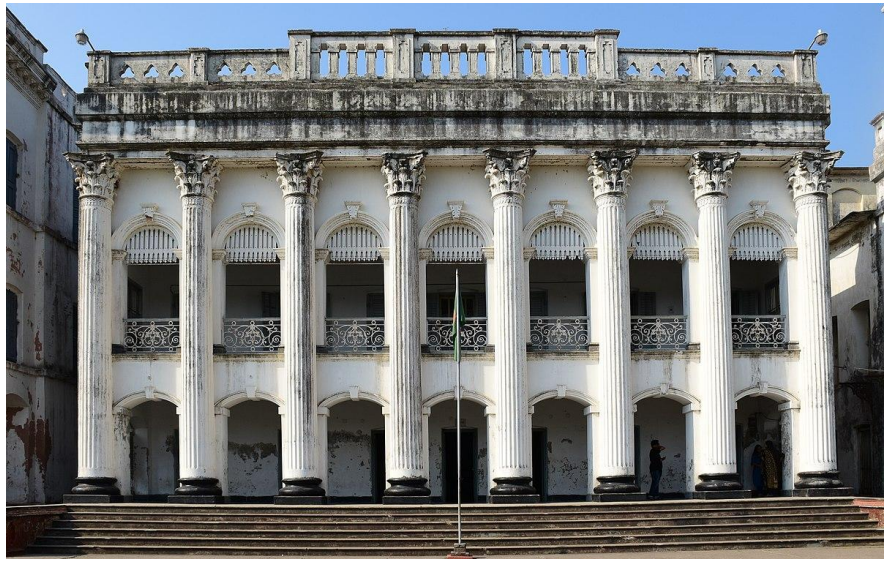
SONARGAON

- Sonargaon, located near Dhaka, Bangladesh, is one of the oldest capitals of Bengal and a prominent historical and cultural hub. Known as the "Golden Village,". Sonargaon boasts a rich tapestry of heritage, with ancient ruins, traditional crafts, and significant historical sites.



THE BALIATI PALACE

- The Baliati Palace, the home of Gobinda Ram Shaha, a salt merchant who was a Zamindar of the late 18th Century.
- This Zamindar house (‘Bari’) is located 35 miles northwest of Dhaka and in the Manikganj district. The original palace was inherited by Gobinda Ram Shaha’s four sons, who lived in the four main palaces that can be seen today. These were built around 1790.



FOOD



BAKARKHANI



BIRYANI/ KACCHI



LACCHI



HALIM

Other Varieties Of Food: Jilapi, Kabab and Nan, Indian Food, Mexican Food, Italian Food, America Food, Chinese Food.





SPECIALTY OF DHAKA DIVISION:
FOOD

There is a very high demand of the street foods in Dhaka city of Bangladesh. The reasons can be attributed by the tastes and varieties of foods, easily accessibility, low price, readily made, attraction to the foods, and above all, needs of the street people.



Shakrain in Old Dhaka: A celebration of kites and fireworks

- Shakrain, a centuries-old festival, is celebrated at the end of the Bengali month of "Poush" during the winter season. It is primarily a kite-flying festival where residents of Old Dhaka, irrespective of religion, come together in a festive spirit.

Transport



- Dhaka is known as the rickshaw capital of the world.
- The availability of rickshaws and cheap rates have always appealed to us.
- Overtime, CNG-driven autorickshaws have gained popularity for a certain level of safety.
- Public buses are operated by the state-run Bangladesh Road Transport Corporation (BRTC) and by private companies and operators.
- The Sadarghat Port on the banks of the Buriganga River serves for the transport of goods and passengers upriver and to other ports in Bangladesh

Religious Places of Dhaka



St. Mary's Cathedral
[Built- 1956]



International Buddhist Monastery
[Built-1981]



Baitul Mukarram National Mosque
[Built- 1968]



Dhakeshwari Temple
[Built- 12th century]

Renowned Personalities of Dhaka

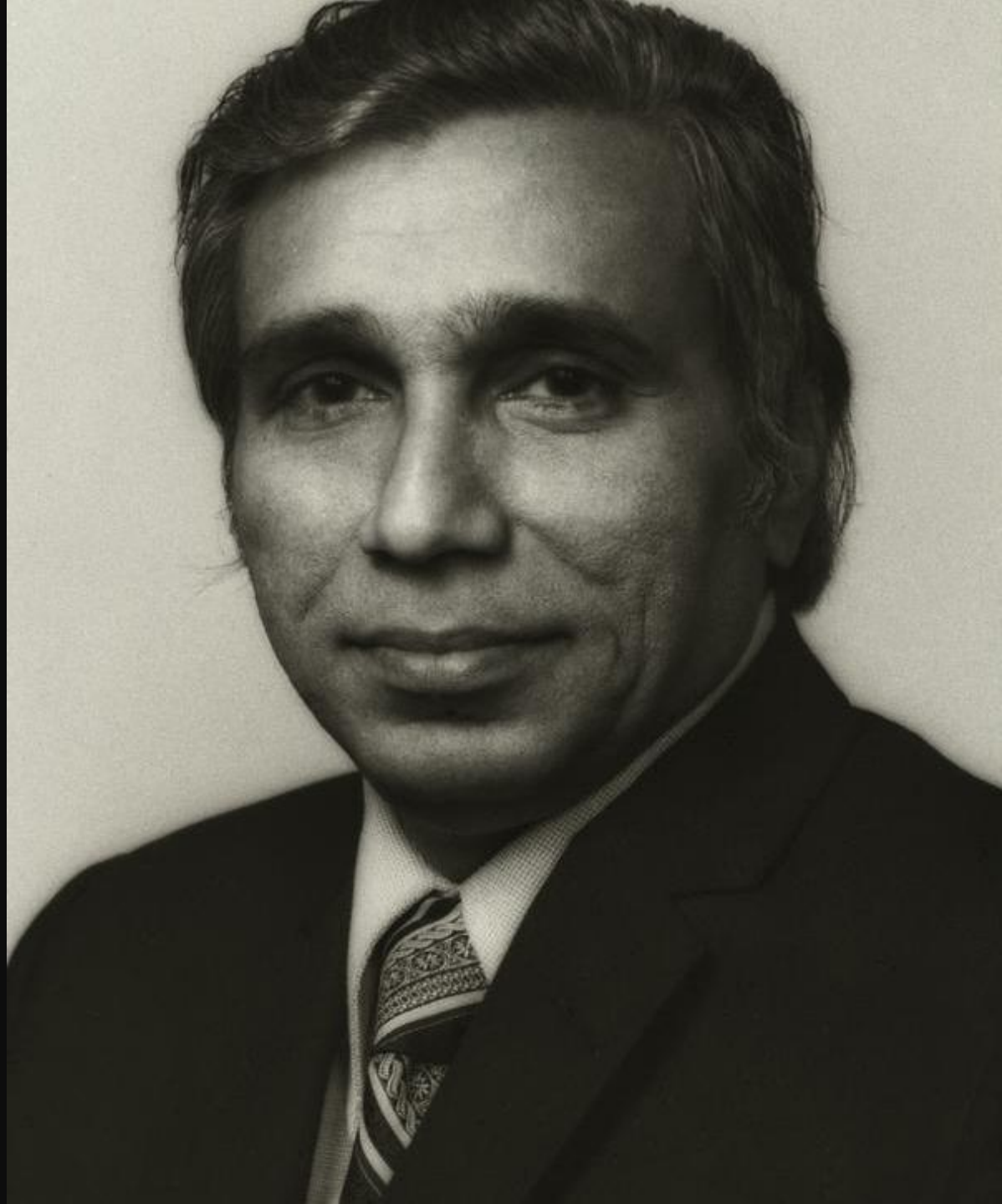


Fazlur Rahman Khan

Birthday: April 3, 1929

Born In: Dhaka, Bangladesh

Fazlur Rahman Khan was a Bangladeshi-born American civil engineer who is remembered for his innovative structural systems, especially in high-rise building construction. Regarded as the "father of tubular designs," he was also a pioneer in computer-aided designs (CAD). Khan later settled in Chicago, a city that eventually became the base for his ground-breaking structural marvels. He brought a revolution in the skyscraper construction technology during the latter half of the 20th century. He was also known as the "Einstein of structural engineering" and amazed the world with some of his masterpieces, such as the 'Sears Tower' (which was the tallest building in the world from 1973 to 1998) and the 'John Hancock Center' (a building that towers over 100 stories).



Sabina Yasmin

The daughter of a singer mother, Sabina Yasmin started her music career as a child artist, appearing in her first stage performance at age 7. She is a 14-time Bangladesh National Film Award-winning playback singer who has also won an Ekushey Padak.



Azam Khan

Azam Khan was a Bangladeshi singer, record producer, and songwriter. He is best remembered as the lead singer of a pop-rock band named Uccharon. Counted among the greatest artists in Bangladeshi popular music history, Khan was honored with the Ekushe Padak posthumously in 2019. His contribution to music also earned him the nicknames, The Rock Guru and The Pop Samrat.



Nawab Bahadur Sir Khwaja Ahsanullah

Nawab Bahadur Sir Khwaja Ahsanullah KCIE (22 August 1846 – 16 December 1901) was the third Nawab of Dhaka. He was notable for his philanthropic works in Bengal, most notably his donations to the present Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology.



Bulbul Ahmed

Bulbul Ahmed (born Tabarruk Ahmed; 4 September 1941 – 15 July 2010) was a Bangladeshi actor and director. He won the Bangladesh National Film Award for Best Actor award three times for his roles in the films Shimana Periye (1977), Badhu Biday (1978) and Shesh Uttar (1980). Besides, he was the producer of the film Rajlakshmi Srikanta (1987) which won the Best Film award.



Disadvantages of living in Dhaka City

- Dhaka is very well known for its traffic jam which engulfs thousands of hours every day from people of different categories starting from school-going kids to office-going adults.
- Almost 60% of Dhaka city is polluted ranking Dhaka as one of the most polluted and non-inhabiting cities to live in.
- Dhaka being one of the most populous cities raises a lot of problems itself.



Problems of Dhaka

- Traffic Jam
- High Population density
- Slum Dwelling
- Pollution
- Crimes
- Urban Poverty
- Food Adulteration







SOURCES

- https://en.banglapedia.org/index.php/Dhaka_Division
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dhaka_Division
- https://www.dhakatribune.com/bangladesh/dhaka/291165/census-2022-dhaka-division-home-to-44-million
- https://worldpopulationreview.com/cities/bangladesh/dhak
- a
- https://www.mindat.org/loc-286103.html
- http://www.ugc-universities.gov.bd/
- https://www.thedailystar.net/news/bangladesh/news/shakrain-old-dhaka-celebration-kites-and-fireworks-3798246